

Vehicle Maintenance

Regular Maintenance Checks

A well-maintained vehicle is safer, more fuel-efficient, and more reliable. Perform these checks regularly.

Engine Oil

- Check oil level using the dipstick — should be between MIN and MAX marks
- Change oil at intervals recommended by the manufacturer (typically every 5,000-10,000 km)
- Low oil level can cause engine overheating and severe damage
- Dark, gritty oil should be changed

Coolant

- Check coolant level in the overflow tank — should be between MIN and MAX
- Never open the radiator cap when the engine is hot — risk of scalding
- Low coolant leads to engine overheating
- Top up with the correct type of coolant, not just water

Brake Fluid

- Check brake fluid level in the reservoir — should be between MIN and MAX
- Low brake fluid may indicate brake pad wear or a leak
- Replace brake fluid every 2 years or as recommended
- If the brake pedal feels spongy, have the braking system inspected immediately

Power Steering Fluid

- Check level regularly if your vehicle has hydraulic power steering
- Low fluid makes steering heavy and difficult
- Unusual noises when turning may indicate low fluid or a problem

Tires

- Minimum tread depth: **1.6 mm** for cars
- Check tire pressure at least monthly — refer to the sticker on the driver's door frame or manual
- Inspect for cracks, bulges, or embedded objects (nails, glass)

- Rotate tires every 10,000 km for even wear
- Ensure the spare tire is inflated and in good condition
- Under-inflated tires increase fuel consumption and risk of blowout
- Over-inflated tires reduce grip and ride comfort

Lights

- Check all lights regularly: headlights (high/low), tail lights, brake lights, turn signals, reverse lights, hazard lights
- Replace burnt-out bulbs immediately
- Clean headlight lenses for maximum visibility

Wipers

- Replace wiper blades when they streak or leave unwiped areas
- Keep the windshield washer fluid topped up
- Worn wipers are dangerous in rain — reduced visibility

Battery

- Check battery terminals are clean and free of corrosion
- Ensure connections are tight
- A battery typically lasts 2-4 years — replace before it fails
- Signs of a weak battery: slow cranking, dim lights when starting

Horn

- Must be in working condition at all times — it is a legal requirement
- Test regularly

Safety Equipment

Seatbelts

- Wearing a seatbelt is **mandatory by law** for the driver and all passengers
- Front and rear passengers must buckle up
- A seatbelt reduces the risk of fatal injury by up to **45%** for front-seat occupants
- The seatbelt should sit across the chest and lap — never behind the back or under the arm
- Penalty for not wearing a seatbelt: fine of up to RM300 and demerit points

Child Seats / Child Restraint Systems

- Children must be secured in an appropriate child restraint system based on their age, weight, and height
- **Rear-facing seat:** For infants and toddlers (typically up to 2 years or 13 kg)
- **Forward-facing seat:** For young children (typically 2-4 years or up to 18 kg)
- **Booster seat:** For older children (typically 4-12 years or until 136 cm tall)
- Child seats must be installed in the **rear seat** of the vehicle
- Never place a rear-facing child seat in front of an active airbag

First Aid Kit

- Recommended to carry a basic first aid kit in the vehicle
- Should include: bandages, antiseptic, adhesive plasters, scissors, gloves, CPR mask
- Check and replace expired items regularly

Fire Extinguisher

- Recommended to carry a small fire extinguisher (1 kg dry powder type)
- Know how to use it: Pull pin, Aim at base of fire, Squeeze handle, Sweep side to side
- Check expiry date regularly
- Store in an accessible location in the car

Warning Triangle

- Must be carried in the vehicle — required by law

- Place at least **50 meters behind your vehicle** if you break down or are in an accident on a regular road
- On highways, place the triangle at least **100 meters** behind your vehicle
- The triangle alerts approaching traffic to slow down and be cautious

Spare Tire and Tools

- Ensure the spare tire is inflated and in good condition
- Know how to use the jack and wheel wrench to change a tire
- A spare tire is typically a temporary tire — do not exceed 80 km/h and replace with a full-size tire as soon as possible

Headrest

- Adjust the headrest to the correct height — the center should be at ear level
- Protects against whiplash injury in a rear-end collision
- Do not remove headrests from the vehicle

KEJARA Demerit System

What is KEJARA?

KEJARA (Skim Kejara) is the demerit point system used by JPJ (Road Transport Department) to track traffic offenses. Points accumulate on your driving record when you commit traffic violations.

Consequences by License Type

- **PDL (P License) — 20 points:** License is **cancelled**. You must re-register and retake all tests from the beginning.
- **CDL (Full License) — 40 points:** License is **suspended for 6 months**.
- **CDL — 60 points:** License is **suspended for 12 months**.
- **CDL — 80 points or more:** License is **revoked**. Must retake all tests.

Common Car-Related Offenses and Demerit Points

- **Speeding (exceeding limit by 1-25 km/h):** 5 points
- **Speeding (exceeding limit by 26-50 km/h):** 10 points
- **Speeding (exceeding limit by more than 50 km/h):** 15 points
- **Running a red traffic light:** 10 points
- **Using a mobile phone while driving:** 10 points
- **Not wearing a seatbelt (driver):** 5 points
- **Not wearing a seatbelt (passenger):** 3 points
- **Dangerous or reckless driving:** 15 points
- **Driving under the influence of alcohol/drugs:** 20 points
- **Failing to stop after an accident:** 15 points
- **Driving without a valid license:** 10 points
- **Overtaking on double lines:** 10 points
- **Not obeying traffic signs:** 5 points
- **Illegal U-turn:** 5 points
- **Driving with expired road tax or insurance:** 5 points

Alcohol and Driving

- **P license holders:** Blood alcohol content must be **0%** — absolute zero tolerance
- **CDL holders:** Blood alcohol content must not exceed **0.08%** (80 mg per 100 ml of blood)
- Penalties for drink driving include: heavy fines, license suspension/revocation, and imprisonment
- Even one drink can impair judgment, reaction time, and coordination

Signs Commonly Violated



How to Check Your Demerit Points

- Visit the JPJ website or counter
- Use the MyJPJ mobile application
- Points reset only after the suspension or revocation period ends

Reducing Risk

- Always follow traffic rules and road signs
- Drive within the speed limit
- Never drive under the influence of alcohol or drugs
- Always wear your seatbelt and ensure all passengers do the same
- Never use a mobile phone while driving — pull over if you need to make a call
- Attend road safety courses if available — some programs may reduce demerit points

Speed Limits

Speed Limits by Road Type

- **Residential areas / school zones:** 30 km/h
- **Town / built-up areas:** 50 km/h
- **State roads (jalan negeri):** 60–80 km/h
- **Federal roads (jalan persekutuan):** 90 km/h
- **Highways / expressways:** 110 km/h

Posted Speed Signs

- Speed limits can be **changed by signs** — always follow the posted speed limit signs on the road
- A speed limit sign overrides the default limit for that road type
- The speed limit applies until the next speed sign or an end-of-restriction sign

Minimum Speed on Highways

- On highways, there is typically a **minimum speed of 60 km/h** on the left lane
- Driving too slowly on a highway is dangerous and can cause accidents
- If your vehicle cannot maintain the minimum speed, do not use the highway

Adjusting Speed Below the Limit

Even when the speed limit allows a higher speed, you should reduce your speed in the following situations:

- **Bad weather** — Rain, fog, or strong winds reduce visibility and road grip
- **Heavy traffic** — Slow down when traffic is dense to maintain safe following distance
- **School zones** — Children may cross the road unexpectedly
- **Construction zones** — Workers and equipment may be near the road
- **Residential areas** — Pedestrians, cyclists, and parked cars create hazards
- **Night driving** — Your visibility is limited to your headlight range

Penalties for Speeding

- **Exceeding limit by 1–25 km/h:** 5 demerit points + fine
- **Exceeding limit by 26–50 km/h:** 10 demerit points + fine

- **Exceeding limit by more than 50 km/h:** 15 demerit points + fine
- Fines increase with the severity of the offense
- Repeat offenders face heavier penalties including possible license suspension

Key Tips

- Always check for speed limit signs, especially when entering a new area
- Speed kills — the faster you go, the longer it takes to stop and the more severe the impact in a crash
- Adjust your speed to road conditions, not just the posted limit

Accident & Emergency Procedures

Immediate Actions at an Accident Scene

- **Stop immediately** — Do not flee the scene. Hit and run is a serious criminal offense in Malaysia.
- **Turn on hazard lights** — Alert other road users of the incident.
- **Place a warning triangle** — At least **50 meters behind your vehicle** on a normal road, or **100 meters on a highway**.
- **Ensure safety first** — Check for fire, fuel leaks, or other immediate dangers before approaching injured persons.

Calling Emergency Services

- **999** — Police, ambulance, and fire department (Malaysia emergency number)
- **112** — Universal emergency number (works on all mobile phones, even without a SIM card)
- Provide your location, number of vehicles involved, and whether there are injuries
- Stay on the line until the operator confirms your details

Handling Injured Persons

- **Do not move injured persons** unless there is immediate danger such as fire or explosion risk
- Moving an injured person incorrectly can worsen spinal or neck injuries
- If trained, provide **first aid** — control bleeding, keep the person warm, and monitor breathing
- Reassure the injured person and keep them calm until help arrives

Exchanging Information

- Exchange the following with all other parties involved:
- **Name and IC number** (identity card number)
- **Driving license details**
- **Insurance information** (company name and policy number)
- **Vehicle registration number**
- Take photos of the damage, the scene, and the positions of all vehicles

Making a Police Report

- You must make a **police report within 24 hours** of the accident
- Bring your driving license, IC, and vehicle registration documents
- The police report is required for insurance claims

Minor Accidents

- If the accident is minor and both vehicles can be moved, move them to the **side of the road** to avoid blocking traffic
- On highways, move to the **emergency lane** and stand behind the safety barrier
- Do not stand in the middle of the road or on the highway

Important Reminders

- **Do not admit fault** at the scene — let the police and insurance companies determine liability
- Do not argue with the other party — stay calm and cooperative
- Failing to stop after an accident carries **15 demerit points** and severe legal penalties

Effects of Alcohol & Drugs

How Alcohol Affects Driving

- Alcohol **slows reaction time** — you take longer to respond to hazards
- Alcohol **impairs judgment** — you may take risks you would normally avoid
- Alcohol **reduces coordination** — steering, braking, and gear changes become less precise
- Alcohol **affects vision** — blurred vision, poor depth perception, and reduced peripheral vision
- Alcohol creates a **false sense of confidence** — you may feel capable even when you are impaired

Legal Blood Alcohol Concentration (BAC) Limits

- **CDL holders:** Maximum BAC of **0.08%** (80 mg of alcohol per 100 ml of blood)
- **P license holders:** BAC must be **0%** — absolute zero tolerance
- Even below the legal limit, alcohol affects your driving ability — the safest option is to not drink at all before driving

Penalties for Drink Driving

- Fine of up to **RM2,000**
- Imprisonment of up to **12 months**
- **License suspension or revocation**
- **20 demerit points** under the KEJARA system
- Repeat offenders face heavier penalties

Effects of Drugs on Driving

- **Illegal drugs** (marijuana, methamphetamine, heroin, etc.) severely impair driving ability and are a criminal offense
- **Prescription medications** can also impair driving — always read warning labels on medication
- Medications that cause drowsiness, dizziness, or blurred vision should not be taken before driving
- If in doubt, ask your doctor or pharmacist whether it is safe to drive while taking the medication

Fatigue and Drowsy Driving

- Fatigue is **as dangerous as drunk driving** — it slows reaction time and impairs judgment
- **Signs of fatigue:** frequent yawning, heavy eyelids, drifting between lanes, difficulty focusing, missing exits
- If you feel tired while driving: **stop at a rest area and take a nap** (at least 15–20 minutes)
- Do not rely on coffee, energy drinks, or loud music alone to stay awake — these are only temporary fixes

Planning Long Journeys

- Plan regular rest stops — take a break **every 2 hours** of driving
- Share driving duties with another licensed driver if possible
- Avoid driving during hours when you would normally be sleeping
- Get a full night of sleep before a long journey

Traffic Police Hand Signals

Authority of Traffic Police

When a traffic police officer is directing traffic, their signals **OVERRIDE** all traffic lights and road signs. You must always obey the officer's directions, even if they contradict what the traffic lights show.

Key Hand Signals

- **Officer facing you with palm raised toward you** — STOP. This is equivalent to a red light. You must not proceed.
- **Officer's side facing you with arm extended horizontally** — You may proceed. Traffic flowing parallel to the officer's outstretched arm may go.
- **Officer beckoning you with hand** — Move forward in the direction the officer is beckoning. Follow the officer's gesture.
- **Officer waving arm up and down** — Slow down. Reduce your speed as you approach.

Important Rules

- **Always obey police signals** even if they contradict traffic lights — the officer's directions take priority
- **Slow down** when approaching a junction where an officer is directing traffic
- Do not honk impatiently at an officer — wait for your signal to proceed
- If you are unsure of the officer's signal, stop and wait for a clearer instruction

Understanding the Officer's Position

- If the officer is **facing you or has their back to you**, you must STOP — you are seeing the "red light" equivalent
- If the officer's **side is facing you** (left or right shoulder pointing at you), you may proceed — you are seeing the "green light" equivalent
- Watch for additional hand gestures that may direct you to turn left, turn right, or go straight

Other Situations with Police Signals

- Police officers may set up roadblocks — slow down and follow their instructions
- At accident scenes, police officers may direct traffic around the scene — follow their signals carefully

- During events or emergencies, police may override normal traffic flow — always comply

Key Tips

- Stay alert and watch the officer's hand movements carefully
- Make eye contact with the officer when possible to confirm their signal is directed at you
- Proceed smoothly and predictably — do not make sudden movements
- Failure to obey a traffic police officer's signal is an offense carrying demerit points and fines